dendrite

a dub echo that grows around your head

v1.0 · vst3 · au · windows · macos

dendrite is a dotted-eighth dub echo that locks to your project's tempo. Every repeat steps a little further out from the middle, so the echo grows from inside your head to all around it, while the mono sum stays a clean dub echo. It ducks while you play and swells in the gaps. And when a part repeats for too long, it gets an itch.



THREE PLACES TO BEGIN

Dub stab
dub 50 · around 30
throw the last stab

Voice into the walls
drown 70 · envelop 65
on headphones, itch off

A loop that wakes up
whisper 25 · around 40
itch 4, then leave it be

1 the field: drag the light

One point, two directions. The light glows with what you hear.

up	**feed**, how long the repeats live whisper › dub › drown › endless
right	**space**, where they live inside › around › envelop › beyond

Every hit you play grows a branch, and the repeats branch off it at the dotted ⅛ and the ¼. Far right, the repeats dissolve and slowly turn around you.

shift-drag	fine moves
double-click	back to dub 50 · around 40
mouse wheel	feed (sideways: space)

4 tempo and mono

The chip shows the echo time; its dot lights while the song plays. **mono-safe** is a promise: fold the mix to mono and the space disappears cleanly, leaving a plain dub echo with nothing hollow or phasey.

2 throw

Hold to throw what's playing into the echo. While you hold, the send opens and the repeats jump louder and step out to one side. Let go, and they fall back over about two bars and drift home.

Throw the last word of a line, a snare at the end of a phrase, a chord stab. Map **throw** to a pad or a key in Live (Ctrl+M or Ctrl+K). At the very bottom, **off**, only what you throw reaches the echo: the dub engineer's closed send.

3 itch

Choose how long dendrite can stand the same thing: **1 to 8 bars**, or off. It listens every sixteenth. When a stretch sounds like the ones before it, it grows restless (the three dots), then grabs the loudest hit of the last bar and three heads answer:

scream	a rising throat that sweeps across your head
laugh	ha, ha, ha, bouncing left and right, slowing down
manipulate	the hit slowed down and turned around you

After every itch comes a full stretch of quiet. The longer a loop runs unchanged, the harder it itches.

START HERE

1. Put dendrite **straight on a track**. The dry sound passes untouched and the echo is added on top, so there is no mix knob and no return track to set up.
2. Play. The default, dub · around, already works.
3. Hold **throw** on the last hit of a phrase.
4. Move the light while it plays: up for longer, right for wider.

GOOD TO KNOW

- No latency, nothing to set up, no mix knob.
- **endless** keeps everything ringing while you play and fades slowly when you stop. The echo is never louder than what you played into it.
- A safety limiter at −0.3 dBFS. Bypass fades out in 30 ms.
- Install: copy **dendrite.vst3** to **C:\Program Files\Common Files\VST3** and rescan in Live (Settings › Plug-Ins). On a Mac, use **~/Library/Audio/Plug-Ins** (VST3 and Components).

UNDER THE HOOD

- Two tape heads in one loop, the dotted ⅛ and the ¼. The ⅛ keeps the side and the ¼ crosses it: the dub ping.
- Every pass loses a little top and gains a little grit, like tape, and wobbles with a slow wow that never repeats.
- It breathes: it ducks under what you play and swells on its own by up to 3 dB.
- space only ever moves the side. The middle never hears it, which is why dendrite is mono-safe.